airstrip, they were then loaded onto the Otters that were working overtime to bring in additional troops.

Madiah had the entire day to study Yellow Pimple that was being defended by approximately a hundred Chinese troops. Their supporting heavy mortars and mountain guns were positioned on Ashi Hill. For the Kumaonis to have artillery support, the battery of mountain guns needed to be physically hauled up to Mor Post. Also, the Kumaonis troops at Trijunction only had whatever ammunition the men could carry themselves.

The attack was to be launched at 10 a.m. on 14 November using two companies that would simultaneously assault Yellow Pimple. The previous evening, the Indian artillery guns that had been hauled up to Mor Post during the day had shelled Yellow Pimple, but their fire had been sporadic and wayward. After a while, the guns had fallen silent and the officers and men huddled together in the bitter cold, trying to catch some sleep. Two thousand metres below them, to their east, was the Lohit River flowing past the Walong airfield, while to the north, the ground dropped almost vertically to the Namti Nullah.

Before the two companies earmarked for the assault had started to move towards the firm base, an advance party sent to secure the area was fired at by a Chinese patrol. This forced Madiah to advance the time for the attack by half an hour. Alpha Company under Captain B. N. Singh on the left flank began to advance along a narrow spur, reaching Yellow Pimple from above. However, to get to Yellow Pimple, the Kumaonis had to negotiate a dip in the ground, then scramble up the last forty-five metres or so. Despite their determined efforts, the men just couldn’t get past this defile. The Indian artillery fire proved to be relatively ineffective and the battalion’s 3-inch mortars could not provide fire support.

Bravo Company on the right flank, under the command of Major B. N. Sharma, simultaneously advanced down a shallow valley, which meant that they too would have to climb up the last 180 metres from the southern side to reach the right half of Yellow Pimple. The Chinese reacted violently, bringing down heavy fire on the advancing Kumaonis. On this flank, the battalion mortars were far more effective and the company succeeded in destroying eleven Chinese bunkers. After a while, both Alpha and Bravo Companies were pinned down, around 20 and 150 metres short respectively of the Yellow Pimple perimeter. Unable to either advance or pull back, Sharma asked Madiah for reinforcements. The only reserve that Battalion